

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12386420
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	August 12, 2025
Inventor(s)	Wang; Qiang

Eye tracking apparatus and virtual reality apparatus

Abstract

The disclosure provides an eye tracking apparatus and a virtual reality apparatus. The eye tracking apparatus includes a display screen, a display lens, and an eye tracking camera, the display screen and the display lens being oppositely disposed, and a displaying surface of the display screen facing the display lens; wherein the eye tracking camera is disposed adjacent to an edge of the display screen, a view-finding side of the eye tracking camera faces the display lens, an included angle between an optical axis of the eye tracking camera and an optical axis of the display lens ranges from 8.5° to 9.5°, and the eye tracking camera receives light passing through the display lens.

Inventors:	Wang; Qiang (Beijing, CN)
Applicant:	Beijing Zitiao Network Technology Co., Ltd. (Beijing, CN)
Family ID:	91280667
Assignee:	Beijing Zitiao Network Technology Co., Ltd. (Beijing, CN)
Appl. No.:	18/527951
Filed:	December 04, 2023

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20240184358 A1	Jun. 06, 2024

Foreign Application Priority Data

CN	202211559255.2	Dec. 06, 2022
----	----------------	---------------

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: G09G5/00 (20060101); G02B27/00 (20060101); G02B27/01 (20060101); G02B27/10 (20060101); G02B27/28 (20060101); G06F3/01 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC G06F3/013 (20130101); G02B27/0093 (20130101); G02B27/0101 (20130101); G02B27/0172 (20130101); G02B27/10 (20130101); G02B27/28 (20130101); G02B2027/0138 (20130101)

Field of Classification Search

CPC: G06F (3/013); G02B (27/0093); G02B (27/0101); G02B (27/0172); G02B (27/10); G02B (27/28); G02B (2027/0138)

USPC: 345/156

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
10514544	12/2018	Yoon	N/A	G02B 27/017
2022/0397765	12/2021	Cakmakci	N/A	G02B 17/0856
2023/0281835	12/2022	Gruhlke	382/100	G02B 27/0093
2023/0384584	12/2022	Kelly	N/A	G02B 27/0081
2024/0015410	12/2023	Kassner	N/A	G06F 3/013
2024/0171846	12/2023	Zhu	N/A	G02B 5/3025

Primary Examiner: Nguyen; Jennifer T

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Alleman Hall & Tuttle LLP

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION(S)

(1) This application claims priority to Chinese Application No. 202211559255.2 filed Dec. 6, 2022, the disclosure of which is incorporated herein by reference in its entity.

FIELD

(2) The disclosure relates to the wearable technology, and more particularly relates to an eye tracking apparatus and a virtual reality apparatus.

BACKGROUND

(3) With advancements in technologies of VR (Virtual Reality) equipment, eye tracking interactions have been extended from gaze tracking to various features and scenario applications, such as IPD adjustment, foveated rendering, and virtual-real fusion alignment.

(4) Conventional eye tracking techniques mainly employ corneal reflection, i.e., enabling eye tracking by computing movements of pupil center based on corneal reflected spots of the light emitted by multiple LEDs.

(5) However, with decreasing miniaturization of VR glasses, image recognition accuracy of corneal reflection-based eye tracking solutions is deteriorated, which further affects eye tracking accuracy

of the VR glasses.

SUMMARY

(6) The disclosure provides an eye tracking apparatus and a virtual reality apparatus so as to solve the problem of deteriorated eye tracking accuracy caused by miniaturization of VR glasses in conventional technologies.

(7) In one aspect, the disclosure provides an eye tracking apparatus, comprising a display screen, a display lens, and an eye tracking camera, the display screen and the display lens being oppositely disposed, and a displaying surface of the display screen facing the display lens; wherein the eye tracking camera is disposed adjacent to an edge of the display screen, a view-finding side of the eye tracking camera faces the display lens, an included angle between an optical axis of the eye tracking camera and an optical axis of the display lens ranges from 8.5° to 9.5° , and the eye tracking camera receives light passing through the display lens.

(8) During use of the eye tracking apparatus provided according to the disclosure, eyes of a wearer are located at a side of the display lens facing away from the display screen so that the wearer may watch contents displayed on the display screen. By disposing the eye tracking camera adjacent to an edge of the display screen, i.e., the eye tracking apparatus and the display screen being both disposed at the side of the display lens facing away from the wearer's eyes, it may avoid the eye tracking camera from masking the display screen. By disposing the eye tracking camera at a side of the display lens facing away from the wearer's eyes, the included angle between the optical axis of the eye tracking camera and the gaze direction of the eyes is reduced, thusly further reducing the RSM radius of imaged spots at various parts in an observation area of the eye tracking camera and increasing spot resolving accuracy. Moreover, by setting the included angle between the optical axis of the eye tracking camera and the optical axis of the display lens to range from 8.5° to 9.5° , the eye tracking apparatus achieves a higher spot resolving accuracy, ensuring that the observation area **101** of the eye tracking camera **300** can cover movement extent of the eye **400**, thereby enhancing overall performance of the eye tracking apparatus.

(9) In addition, by disposing the eye tracking camera adjacent to an edge of the display screen, the size of the eye tracking apparatus is reduced, thereby realizing miniaturization of the eye tracking apparatus. Moreover, by disposing the eye tracking camera adjacent to an edge of the display screen, built-in of the eye tracking camera is realized, which avoids the eye tracking camera from affecting the outer appearance of the eye tracking apparatus.

(10) In another aspect, the disclosure further provides a virtual reality apparatus. The virtual reality apparatus comprises the eye tracking apparatus described supra.

(11) The display apparatus provided by the disclosure has same technical features as the eye tracking apparatus described supra and can achieve same technical effects, which will not be detailed here.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The drawings provided herein are incorporated into the specification and constitute part of the specification, which illustrate embodiments in accordance with the disclosure and serve to explain the principles of the disclosure together with the specification.

(2) FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram of an eye tracking apparatus worn on the head in some optional embodiments of the disclosure;

(3) FIG. 2 is a schematic diagram of a relative position between a display screen and a display lens in some optional embodiments of the disclosure;

(4) FIG. 3 is a sectional view of the eye tracking apparatus in some optional embodiments of the disclosure;

- (5) FIG. 4 is a schematic diagram of imaging of the eye tracking camera when the eye tracking apparatus is at a first angle of view in some optional embodiments of the disclosure;
- (6) FIG. 5 is a schematic diagram of imaging of the eye tracking camera when the eye tracking apparatus is at a second angle of view in some optional embodiments of the disclosure;
- (7) FIG. 6 is an optical path diagram of imaging of the eye tracking camera in some optional embodiments of the disclosure;
- (8) FIG. 7 is a local enlarged view of an optical path between the eye tracking camera and the display lens in FIG. 6;
- (9) FIG. 8 is a structural schematic diagram of the display lens in some optional embodiments of the disclosure;
- (10) FIG. 9A is a spot diagram of a first field of the eye tracking camera in some optional embodiments of the disclosure;
- (11) FIG. 9B is a spot diagram of a second field of the eye tracking camera in some optional embodiments of the disclosure;
- (12) FIG. 9C is a spot diagram of a third field of the eye tracking camera in some optional embodiments of the disclosure;
- (13) FIG. 9D is a spot diagram of a fourth field of the eye tracking camera in some optional embodiments of the disclosure;
- (14) FIG. 9E is a spot diagram of a fifth field of the eye tracking camera in some optional embodiments of the disclosure;
- (15) FIG. 9F is a spot diagram of a sixth field of the eye tracking camera in some optional embodiments of the disclosure;
- (16) FIG. 9G is a spot diagram of a seventh field of the eye tracking camera in some optional embodiments of the disclosure;
- (17) FIG. 10 is a schematic diagram of a modulation transfer function corresponding to imaging of the eye tracking camera in some optional embodiments of the disclosure;
- (18) FIG. 11A is a field curvature analysis diagram corresponding to imaging of the eye tracking apparatus in some optional embodiments of the disclosure;
- (19) FIG. 11B is a distortion analysis diagram corresponding to imaging of the eye tracking apparatus in some optional embodiments of the disclosure;
- (20) FIG. 12 is a grid distortion analysis diagram corresponding to imaging of the eye tracking camera in some optional embodiments of the disclosure;
- (21) FIG. 13 is a schematic diagram of a field relative illumination corresponding to eye tracking camera imaging in some optional embodiments of the disclosure.
- (22) Reference Numerals: **101**—observation area; **100**—display screen; **200**—display lens; **210**—visible light beam splitting film; **220**—infrared light transmissive film; **230**—polarizing film; **240**—reflective polarizing film; **250**—quarter-wave plate; **300**—eye tracking camera; **400**—eye; **500**—housing.
- (23) Embodiments of the disclosure have been illustrated in the above figures and will be described in more detail. The figures and written description are not intended for limiting the scope of the idea of the disclosure in any manner, but for illustrating the idea of the disclosure to those skilled in the art by referring to specific example embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENTS

(24) Example embodiments will be described here. Examples of the embodiments are illustrated in the drawings. Identical numerals in different figures represent same or like elements throughout the description referring to the figures, unless otherwise indicated. The implementations described in the example embodiments do not represent all implementations in compliance with the disclosure. Instead, they are only examples of the apparatus and method in compliance with some aspects of the disclosure as stated in the appended claims.

(25) In conventional corneal reflection-based VR glasses, a hot mirror is provided for disposing a

camera in the glasses. Specifically, for head-mounted VR glasses, the eyes and the camera are disposed at a same side of the hot mirror, with the camera being disposed opposite outer corners of the eyes. During eye tracking, the reflected light from the corneas beams into the hot mirror and is reflected therefrom again. The light reflected from the hot mirror is illuminated into the camera again, so that the camera receives the reflected light reflected from the hot mirror and obtains positions of the eyeballs based on the camera imaging. In this way, eye tracking is implemented. To ensure spot resolving accuracy, the hot mirror needs to be disposed inclinedly relative to the eyes. However, inclined setting of the hot mirror would increase the tube length of the VR glasses, which is disadvantageous to miniaturization design of the VR glasses.

(26) To address this problem, embodiments of the disclosure provide an eye tracking apparatus. Specifically, a display screen and an eye tracking camera in the eye tracking apparatus are disposed at the side of a display lens facing away from the eyes. The eye tracking camera and the display screen are arranged in juxtaposition, and the eye tracking camera is adjacent to an edge of the display screen, which improves compactness between the eye tracking camera and the display screen in the eye tracking apparatus and is advantageous to reduce the overall size of the eye tracking apparatus.

(27) Furthermore, a displaying-surface side of the display screen is opposite the display lens, and a view-finding side of the eye tracking camera faces the display lens, so that the eye tracking camera may directly receive the light passing through the lens and generate an image. As such, the eye tracking apparatus according to embodiments of the disclosure is advantageous to reduce the included angle between an optical axis corresponding to the eye tracking camera and an optical axis corresponding to the display lens, further improving spot resolving accuracy. Moreover, the eye tracking apparatus provided by the disclosure eliminates a need of setting an inclined hot mirror, which avoids occupation of a relative large space by the inclined hot mirror, and is thusly advantageous to reduce the overall size of the eye tracking apparatus so as to be adapted to miniaturization design of the eye tracking apparatus, and which also solves the problem of deteriorated eye tracking accuracy accompanied with miniaturization of the eye tracking apparatus.

(28) Hereinafter, the technical solution of the disclosure and the technical means employed by the technical solution of the disclosure in solving the technical problem will be described in detail through specific example embodiments. The specific example embodiments described infra may be combined with each other, and same or similar concepts or processes might be omitted in some example embodiments. Hereinafter, FIGS. 1 through 13 will be referenced to describe the embodiments of the disclosure.

(29) Referring to FIGS. 4 to 7, in some optional embodiments, the eye tracking apparatus according to the disclosure comprises a display screen **100**, a display lens **200** and an eye tracking camera **300**, wherein the display screen **100** is configurable to display an image watched by an eye **400**. The display screen **100** is disposed opposite the display lens **200**, and a displaying surface of the display screen **100** faces the display lens **200**. The displaying surface of the display screen **100** is a surface of the display screen **100** which displays the image watched by the eye **400**.

(30) Optionally, as illustrated in FIG. 2, in a case that the eye tracking apparatus is worn on the head, the displaying surface of the display screen **100** faces the eye **400**, and the display lens **200** is disposed between the display screen **100** and the eye **400**, so that light of the display screen **100** for displaying an image may pass through the display lens **200** to beam into the eye **400**, so that the eye **400** may watch the image displayed on the display screen **100**. Exemplarily, the display lens **200** is configurable to amplify and project the image displayed on the display screen **100** into the eye **400**.

(31) Referring to FIGS. 4 to 7, the eye tracking camera **300** is disposed adjacent an edge of the display screen **100**. A view-finding side of the eye tracking camera **300** faces the display lens **200**, and the eye tracking camera **300** receives light passing through the display lens **200**.

(32) Exemplarily, the eye tracking camera **300** and the display screen **100** may be disposed in

juxtaposition perpendicular to an optical axis direction of the display lens **200**, and the eye tracking camera **300** is adjacent to a side wall of the display screen **100**. On one hand, this solution may avoid the eye tracking camera **300** from shading the display screen **100** and reduces the distance between the eye tracking camera **300** and the display screen **100**. On the other hand, this solution may also avoid increasing the size of the eye tracking apparatus in the optical axis direction of the display lens **200**. Moreover, compared with conventional technologies, this solution eliminates a need of setting a hot mirror, so that the size of the eye tracking apparatus in the optical axis direction of the display lens **200** is reduced compared with setting of the hot mirror. Therefore, the eye tracking apparatus solution disclosed in this example embodiment is advantageous to miniaturization design of the eye tracking apparatus. Additionally, the eye tracking camera **300** is disposed at a side of the display lens **200** facing away from the wearer's eye **400**, which is advantageous to reduce the included angle between the optical axis of the eye tracking camera **300** and the gaze of the eye, thereby improving spot resolving accuracy, bettering imaging quality of the eye tracking camera **300**, and increasing eye tracking accuracy of the eye tracking apparatus. Therefore, this solution is advantageous to solve the problem of deteriorated eye tracking accuracy due to miniaturization of the eye tracking apparatus.

(33) In some optional embodiments, the display lens may employ a Pancake solution. Specifically, the display lens **200** may realize light transmission and angle-of-view amplification within a narrow space using multiple times of back-and-forth bouncing of polarizing light, which reduces the size of the eye tracking apparatus in the gaze direction of the eye.

(34) In some optional embodiments, the display screen **100** may be an OLED screen, which is advantageous to reduce thickness of the display screen **100** and reduce power consumption of the display screen **100**.

(35) Referring to FIGS. 5, 6, and 7, in some optional embodiments, the center of the display screen **100** is located on the optical axis of the display lens **200**. A radial distance from the center to the edge of the display lens **200** is referred to as a first distance **L10**, and a vertical distance between the eye tracking camera **300** and the center of the display screen **100** is referred to as a second distance **L11**, the first distance **L10** being greater than or equal to the second distance **L11**.

(36) As an optional embodiment, the center of the display lens **200** may be the optical center of the display lens **200**. Exemplarily, the optical center of the display lens **200** may coincide with the geometric center of the display lens **200**. Further optionally, a cross section of the display lens **200** in the direction perpendicular to the optical axis is circular, so that the first distance **L10** is the radius of the display lens **200** in the direction perpendicular to the optical axis. The center of the display screen **100** may be a symmetric center of the displaying surface of the display screen **100**. Exemplarily, the displaying surface of the display screen **100** may be circular, and the center of the display screen **100** is the center of the displaying surface. Optionally, the displaying surface of the display screen **100** may be rectangular or square, and the center of the display screen **100** is the intersection of the diagonal lines of the displaying surface.

(37) In the example embodiments above, the first distance **L10** is greater than or equal to the second distance **L11**, so that in the eye tracking apparatus, a corresponding distance of the eye tracking camera **300** in the direction perpendicular to the optical axis of the display lens **200** is smaller than or equal to a corresponding distance of the display lens **200** in the direction perpendicular to the optical axis of the display lens **200**. As such, this solution is advantageous to reduce or avoid formation of a projection at the eye tracking camera **300**, further improving aesthetic appearance of the eye tracking apparatus.

(38) In some optional embodiments, the size of the display screen **100** in the direction perpendicular to the optical axis of the display lens **200** is smaller than the size of the display lens **200** in the direction perpendicular to the display lens **200**. Exemplarily, a surface of the display lens **200** facing the display screen **100** has a first area and a second area, wherein the first area refers to a projection area of the display screen **100** on the display lens **200** along the optical axis of the

display lens **200**, and the second area refers to a projection area of the eye tracking camera **300** on the display lens **200** along the optical axis of the display lens **200**, the first area and the second area being arranged in adjacency or at an interval.

(39) Optionally, a vertical distance between an edge of a side of the display screen **100** proximal to the eye tracking camera **300** and the center of the display screen **100** is referred to a third distance **L12**. The third distance **L12** is smaller than the first distance **L10**. Further optionally, a difference between the third distance **L12** and the first distance **L10** in the direction perpendicular to the optical axis of the display lens **200** is greater than or equal to the distance of the eye tracking camera **300** in the direction perpendicular to the display lens **200**.

(40) In the eye tracking apparatus disclosed in the example embodiments above, the size difference between the display screen **100** and the display lens **200** in the direction perpendicular to the optical axis may provide a mounting space for the eye tracking camera **300**, further avoiding the eye tracking camera **300** from increasing the size of the eye tracking apparatus in the direction perpendicular to the optical axis of the display lens **200**, thusly facilitating miniaturization design of the eye tracking apparatus.

(41) In the eye tracking apparatus disclosed in some optional embodiments of the disclosure, the first distance **L10** ranges from 22 mm to 25 mm. Specifically, a too large first distance **L10** would cause a too large size of the eye tracking apparatus at the display lens **200** in the direction perpendicular to the optical axis of the display lens **200**, which would be disadvantages to miniaturization design of the eye tracking apparatus. A too small first distance **L10** would result in a smaller mounting space for the display screen **100** and the eye tracking camera **300**, which requires selecting a miniaturized display screen **100** and/or eye tracking camera **300**, further increasing the costs of the display screen **100** and the eye tracking camera **300**, thusly being disadvantageous to reduce the cost of the eye tracking apparatus.

(42) Optionally, the first distance **L10** may be 23.8 mm, which can avoid a too large distance of the eye tracking apparatus at the display lens **200** in the direction perpendicular to the optical axis of the display lens **200** and can also provide sufficient space for the eye tracking camera **300** and the display screen **100** so as to accommodate the distances of a conventional eye tracking camera **300** and a conventional display screen **100**, thereby being advantageous to selection of the eye tracking camera **300** and the display screen **100**, and reducing manufacture cost of the eye tracking apparatus.

(43) Referring to FIG. 7, in some further optional embodiments, the vertical distance between the edge of the side of the display screen **100** proximal to the eye tracking camera **300** and the center of the display screen **100** ranges from 13 mm to 17 mm. That is, the third distance **L12** ranges from 13 mm to 17 mm. Exemplarily, the display screen **100** takes on a circle shape, and the radius of the display screen **100** ranges from 13 mm to 17 mm. Further optionally, the radius of the display screen **100** is 13.08 mm.

(44) It is noted that, the size of the display screen **100** is positively correlated to the FOV (Field of View). Specifically, when the display lens **200** is given, the larger the size of the display screen **100**, the larger the FOV of the corresponding eye tracking apparatus, thusly the better the provided immersion.

(45) In the above embodiments, on one hand, it is guaranteed that the eye tracking apparatus has a reasonable FOV with an improved immersion, and on the other hand, enough mounting space may be provided for the eye tracking camera **300**.

(46) In some optional embodiments, the size of the eye tracking camera **300** is smaller than or equal to 4 mm*4 mm*4 mm. If the size of the eye tracking camera **300** is greater than 4 mm*4 mm*4 mm, the eye tracking camera **300** would have a poor concealment. However, a smaller size of the eye tracking camera **300** would cause a higher manufacture cost of the eye tracking camera **300**.

(47) As an optional embodiment, the size of the eye tracking camera **300** is 3.5 mm*3.5 mm*3.5

mm. On one hand, this embodiment may ensure that the eye tracking camera **300** may be mounted at an edge of the adjacent display screen **100** and may also provide sufficient space for inclined setting of the eye tracking camera **300**, which may further optimize the performance of the eye tracking apparatus by setting the inclined angle between the optical axis of the eye tracking camera **300** and the display lens **200**. Furthermore, setting the size of the eye tracking camera **300** to 3.5 mm*3.5 mm*3.5 mm facilitates balancing between the concealment and manufacture cost of the eye tracking camera **300**.

(48) In some optional embodiments, an object distance of the eye tracking camera **300** ranges from 28 mm to 37 mm. The object distance of the eye tracking camera **300** refers to the distance from the eye tracking camera **300** to the intersection between the exit pupil plane of the eye **400** and the optical axis of the display lens **200**.

(49) Exemplarily, the object distance of the eye tracking camera **300** is referred to as a fourth distance L13 illustrated in FIG. 6. Specifically, a too large object distance of the eye tracking camera **300** would increase the size of the eye tracking apparatus in the optical axis direction of the display lens **200**, which is disadvantageous to miniaturization design of the eye tracking apparatus. In addition, a too small object distance of the eye tracking camera **300** would affect mounting of the display lens **200** and would be highly demanding on the refractive performance and/or diffractive performance of the display lens **200**, further increasing the manufacture cost of the display lens **200**. As an optional embodiment, the object distance of the eye tracking camera **300** is 33.547 mm, which balances the miniaturization design of the eye tracking apparatus, the mounting space, and the manufacture cost of the display lens **200**. Furthermore, a higher accuracy of the object distance of the eye tracking camera **300** correspondingly imposes a higher demand on the assembly accuracy of the eye tracking apparatus and the distance accuracy between respective components, further increasing the manufacture cost of the eye tracking apparatus. Further optionally, the object distance of the eye tracking camera **300** is set to 33.6 mm, so as to reduce manufacture difficulty of the eye tracking camera **300**.

(50) In an optional embodiment, the exit pupil distance of the display lens **200** ranges from 13 mm to 20 mm. The exit pupil distance refers to the distance from the vertex of a surface of the display lens **200** facing away from the display screen **100** to the intersection between the exit pupil plane of the eye **400** and the optical axis of the display lens **200**. Exemplarily, the exit pupil distance of the display lens **200** is referred to as a fifth distance L14 illustrated in FIG. 6.

(51) It is noted that, the smaller the exit pupil distance of the display lens **200**, the more easily the display lens **200** touches the eyelashes at the eye **400**, affecting wearing comfort of the eye tracking apparatus. Generally, the length of the eyelashes of the eye **400** is less than 12 mm. To this end, in the embodiments described supra, the exit pupil distance of the display lens **200** ranges from 13 mm to 20 mm, which can effectively avoid the eyelashes at the eye **400** from contacting the display lens **200**, further avoiding the display lens **200** from touching the eyelashes at the eye **400**, thereby enhancing wearing comfort of the eye tracking apparatus. However, with increase of the exit pupil distance of the display lens **200**, the space in the eye tracking apparatus for mounting the display lens **200**, the display screen **100**, and/or the eye tracking camera **300** gradually decreases. In the case that the space occupied by the display lens **200**, the display screen **100**, and the eye tracking camera **300** is given, the larger the exit pupil distance of the display lens, the larger the size of the eye tracking apparatus in the optical axis of the display lens **200**. Therefore, a too large exit pupil distance of the display lens is disadvantageous to miniaturization design of the overall size of the eye tracking apparatus.

(52) In some optional embodiments, the exit pupil distance of the display lens **200** is 16 mm. This embodiment facilitates reduction of the size of the eye tracking apparatus in the optical axis direction of the display lens **200**, which may also ensure that for a majority of people, when they are wearing the eye tracking apparatus, the display lens **200** will not touch their eyelashes at the eye **400**, thereby improving wearing comfort of the eye tracking apparatus.

(53) Further optionally, as illustrated in FIG. 6, a distance from the displaying surface of the display screen **100** to the intersection between the exit pupil plane of the eye **400** and the optical axis of the display lens **200** in the optical axis direction of the display lens **200** is referred to as a seventh distance **L16**. Exemplarily, the seventh distance **L16** ranges from 30 mm to 37 mm. Exemplarily, the seventh distance **L16** is 33.5 mm.

(54) In some optional embodiments, the field of view of the eye tracking camera **300** ranges from 70° to 85°. Specifically, a larger field of view of the eye tracking camera **300** is advantageous to increase the size of the imaging area corresponding to the eye tracking camera **300**. However, with increase of the field of view, the resolution accuracy corresponding to the eye tracking camera **300** decreases gradually. Of course, to enhance the resolution accuracy corresponding to the eye tracking camera **300**, the field of view of the eye tracking camera **300** may be reduced. However, a too small field of view of the eye tracking camera **300** would have a consequence that the observation area **101** of the eye tracking camera **300** cannot cover the movement extent of the eye **400**, so that eye movement in some areas cannot be tracked.

(55) The embodiments described supra may determine the size of the observation area **101** based on the field of view of the eye tracking camera **300**, the position of the eye tracking camera **300**, the size of the display lens **200**, and an air spacing parameter between the eye tracking camera **300** and the display lens **200**. Specifically, the embodiments advantageously set a radius of the observation area **101** to range from 20 mm to 30 mm.

(56) It is noted that, during a watching process, the eye **400** would move within a certain extent. The observation area **101** refers to an imaging area of the eye tracking camera **300**. Specifically, to achieve eye tracking, the imaging area of the camera needs to cover the moving extent of the eye **400**. Optionally, the observation area **101** is a circular area. Generally, a 20 mm radius of the observation area **101** suffices to cover the movement extent of the eyes of most population.

(57) Therefore, the observation area **101** of the eye tracking camera **300** in the eye tracking apparatus disclosed in the embodiments above may cover the movement extent of the eyes of most population, which facilitates the eye tracking apparatus to be adapted to eye tracking for different populations. Moreover, in a case that the observation area **101** of the eye tracking camera **300** cannot cover the movement extent of the eye **400**, the field of view of the eye tracking camera **300** may be reduced in favor to achieve a balance between the extent of the observation area **101** of the eye tracking camera **300** and the resolution accuracy of the eye tracking camera **300**.

(58) In some further optional embodiments, the field of view of the eye tracking camera **300** is 71°, so that the radius of the observation area **101** corresponding to the eye tracking camera **300** may be greater than or equal to 20 mm.

(59) In further optional embodiments, the field of view of the eye tracking camera **300** is 74°, so as to avoid assembly error of the eye tracking camera **300** with respect to the display lens **200** and/or other components causing the observation area **101** unable to cover the movement extent of the eye **400**. In further optional embodiments, the field of view of the eye tracking camera **300** ranges from 81° to 84° to reserve an anti-shading angle.

(60) By considering the assembly accuracy between the eye tracking camera **300** and other components with an anti-shading angle reserved, the embodiments described supra ensure that the observation area **101** may cover the movement extent of the eye **400**, further improving yield of the eye tracking apparatus.

(61) Further optionally, the field of view of the eye tracking camera **300** may be further optimized based on the position of the eye tracking camera **300**, the size of the display lens **200**, and the air spacing parameter between the eye tracking camera **300** and the display lens **200**, so as to improve eye tracking accuracy.

(62) Referring to FIG. 3, in some optional embodiments, a distance between the eye tracking camera **300** and a surface of the display lens **200** facing away from the eye tracking camera **300** ranges from 15 mm to 18 mm. In a case that the surface of the display lens **200** facing away from

the eye tracking camera **300** is a convex surface, the distance between the eye tracking camera **300** and the surface of the display lens **200** facing away from the eye tracking camera **300** is the distance between the eye tracking camera **300** and the vertex of the surface of the display lens **200** facing away from the eye tracking camera **300** in the optical axis direction of the display lens **200**. (63) Referring to FIG. 6, in some further optional embodiments, a distance between the eye tracking camera **300** and the vertex of the surface of the display lens **200** facing away from the display screen **100** in the optical axis direction of the display lens **200** is referred to as a sixth distance **L15**.

(64) Exemplarily, the sixth distance **L15** ranges from 15 mm to 18 mm. Exemplarily, the sixth distance **L15** is 16.547 mm.

(65) In the eye tracking apparatus disclosed by some optional embodiments, a resolution of an image produced by the eye tracking camera **300** is 400*400. Specifically, although a too high image resolution produced by the eye tracking camera **300** may enhance imaging definiteness of the eye tracking camera **300**, it would increase processing difficulty of the image produced by the eye tracking camera **300** and increase power consumed for processing the image produced by the eye tracking camera **300**. Specifically, although a too low imaging resolution produced by the eye tracking camera **300** may reduce processing difficulty of the image produced by the eye tracking camera **300** and power consumed by the eye tracking apparatus, it would cause insufficient definiteness of the image produced by the eye tracking camera **300**, further affecting eye tracking accuracy.

(66) In the above embodiments, a resolution of the image produced by the eye tracking camera **300** is 400*400, which achieves a balance between the definiteness of the image produced by the eye tracking camera **300** and the processing difficulty of the image produced by the eye tracking camera **300**, so that power consumption of the eye tracking apparatus is reduced while ensuring the eye tracking accuracy.

(67) In some optional embodiments, an included angle between the optical axis of the eye tracking camera **300** and the optical axis of the display lens **200** ranges from 8.5° to 9.5°, ensuring that the eye tracking camera **300** images clearly and completely. Preferably, the included angle between the optical axis of the eye tracking camera **300** and the optical axis of the display lens **200** is 9.2°. In some optional embodiments, as illustrated in FIG. 7, an included angle between a plane perpendicular to the optical axis of the eye tracking camera **300** and a plane perpendicular to the optical axis of the display lens **200** is denoted as β . The included angle between the optical axis of the eye tracking camera **300** and the optical axis of the display lens **200** is equal to the angle β . Optionally, the angle β is 9.2°.

(68) It is noted that, a too large included angle between the optical axis of the eye tracking camera **300** and the optical axis of the display lens **200** would lead to a larger RMS (Root Mean Square) radius of the imaging spots at various parts in the observation area **101** of the eye tracking camera **300**, further reducing spot resolving accuracy. However, a too small included angle between the optical axis of the eye tracking camera **300** and the optical axis of the display lens **200** would easily result in the observation area **101** of the eye tracking camera **300** failing to cover the entire movement extent of the eye, further causing failure to track movement of the eye **400** in some areas. The eye tracking apparatus disclosed in the embodiments described supra may shrink the included angle between the optical axis of the eye tracking camera **300** and the optical axis of the display lens **200** while ensuring that the observation area **101** of the eye tracking camera **300** covers the movement extent of the eye **400**, further enhancing overall performance of the eye tracking apparatus.

(69) FIG. 9A through FIG. 12 illustrate simulation results of the eye tracking apparatus disclosed in some optional embodiments of the disclosure, wherein the diameter of the observation area **101** of the eye tracking camera **300** is 30 mm, the exit pupil distance of the display lens **200** is 16 mm, the object distance of the eye tracking camera **300** is 33.6 mm, and the included angle between the

optical axis of the eye tracking camera **300** and the optical axis of the display lens **200** is 9.2° . (70) FIG. **9A** through FIG. **9G** are spot diagrams corresponding to the eye tracking camera **300** in the eye tracking apparatus. As illustrated in FIG. **9A** through FIG. **9G**, this simulation selects 7 fields to analyze. As illustrated in FIG. **9A**, the object plane (OBJ) corresponding to the first field is 0.00 mm, and the image plane is 0.000, 0.294 mm. As illustrated in FIG. **9B**, the object plane (OBJ) corresponding to the second field is -5.00 mm, and the image plane is 0.000, 0.417 mm. As illustrated in FIG. **9C**, the object plane (OBJ) corresponding to the third field is 5.00 mm, and the image plane is 0.000, 0.170 mm. As illustrated in FIG. **9D**, the object plane (OBJ) corresponding to the fourth field is -10.00 mm, and the image plane is 0.000, 0.541 mm. As illustrated in FIG. **9E**, the object plane (OBJ) corresponding to the fifth field is 10.00 mm, and the image plane is 0.000, 0.051 mm. As illustrated in FIG. **9F**, the object plane (OBJ) corresponding to the sixth field is -15.00 mm, and the image plane is 0.000, 0.662 mm. As illustrated in FIG. **9G**, the object plane (OBJ) corresponding to the seventh field is 15.00 mm, and the image plane is 0.000, -0.058 mm. Specifically, the RMS (Root mean square) radius and GEO radius corresponding to respective fields are set forth in the table below:

(71) TABLE-US-00001 TABLE 1 Correspondence Table of RMS Radius and GEO Radius Corresponding to Respective Fields in FIG. **9A** through FIG. **9G** Spot Diagrams Unit: μm Airy Radius: 2.587 μm . the legends correspond to wavelengths Field 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 RMS 1.724 2.376 2.209 3.647 2.129 4.204 1.951 Radius: GEO 4.283 7.110 3.760 10.444 3.759 11.250 3.901 Radius: Zoom Bar: 40 Reference: Chief Ray

(72) In Table 1, the GEO radius refers to the maximum radius. It may be seen from FIG. **9** and Table 1 that, the RMS radii of the imaging spots corresponding to the fields other than the fourth field and the sixth field are all smaller than the diffractive extreme radius 2.544. Therefore, the eye tracking camera **300** in the eye tracking apparatus described in the embodiments supra has a higher imaging resolving power.

(73) FIG. **10** illustrates an MTF (Modulation Transfer Function) image corresponding to imaging of the eye tracking camera **300**. Specifically, the longitudinal axis represents the MTF value, and the horizontal axis represents the spatial frequency. Referring to FIG. **10**, at the 42 lp/mm Nyquist frequency, the resolving power of the eye tracking camera **300** with respect to the object in the observation area **101** is $\text{MTF} > 0.7$. It is noted that the MTF value ranges from 0 to 1, which may reflect an image definiteness. Specifically, the closer to 1 the MTF value is, the more powerful a camera's capability to restore the reality, i.e., the clearer the image is. For a sensor with a 400×400 resolution, $\text{MTF} > 0.5$ generally indicates a system with a good imaging quality. Therefore, in the embodiments described supra, the eye tracking camera **300** has a good imaging quality, further ensuring eye tracking accuracy.

(74) FIG. **11A** is a field curvature analysis diagram corresponding to imaging of the eye tracking camera **300** of the eye tracking apparatus in some optional embodiments of the disclosure. FIG. **11B** is a distortion analysis diagram corresponding to imaging of the eye tracking camera in some optional embodiments of the disclosure. Specifically, it may be seen from FIG. **11A** through FIG. **12** that, in the embodiments above, the imaging of the observation area **101** of the eye tracking apparatus on the eye tracking camera **300** has a distortion of about 13%. In some optional embodiments, the distortion of the imaging of the observation area **101** on the eye tracking camera **300** may be corrected by, but not limited to, the CORDIC (Coordinate Rotation Digital Computer) algorithm.

(75) In the eye tracking apparatus disclosed in some optional embodiments, as illustrated in FIG. **8**, the display lens **200** further comprises a visible light beam splitting film **210** and an infrared light transmissive film **220**. The visible light beam splitting film **210** and the infrared light transmissive film **220** are both disposed at a side of the display lens **200** proximal to the eye tracking camera **300**, and the infrared light transmissive film **220** is stacked at a side of the visible light beam splitting film **210** proximal to the eye tracking camera **300**. Exemplarily, the infrared light

transmissive film **220** may be an AR (Anti-Reflectance) film. Furthermore, the visible light beam splitting film **210** and the infrared light transmissive film **220** are composite films of the visible light beam splitting film **210** and the infrared light transmissive film **220**.

(76) In the eye tracking apparatus described in the above embodiments, the visible light beam splitting film **210** and the infrared light transmissive membrane **220** may increase the luminance entering the eye tracking camera **300** to 40% above. FIG. **13** is a schematic diagram of a field relative illumination corresponding to imaging of the eye tracking camera **300** in some optional embodiments of the disclosure. In conjunction with FIG. **13**, it may be directly derived that the relative illumination (RI) value on an image produced by the eye tracking camera **300**: $RI > 80\%$. Therefore, the embodiments described supra are advantageous to prevent occurrence of serious black blocks to imaging of the eye tracking camera **300**.

(77) In the eye tracking apparatus disclosed in some optional embodiments of the disclosure, the display lens **200** further comprises a polarizing film **230**, a reflective polarizing film **240**, and a quarter-wave plate **250**, the reflective polarizing film **240** and the quarter-wave plate **250** being stacked at a side of the polarizing film **230** proximal to the eye tracking camera **300**, the reflective polarizing film **240** being disposed between the quarter-wave plate **250** and the polarizing film **230**, the visible light beam splitting film **210** and the infrared light transmissive film **220** being disposed at a side of the quarter-wave plate **250** proximal to the eye tracking camera **300**. In some optional embodiments, the display lens **200** may comprise a plurality of stacked lenses. Optionally, the polarizing film **230**, the reflective transmissive film **240**, and the quarter-wave plate **250** may be disposed on different lenses.

(78) In some embodiments of the disclosure, light emitted from the display screen **100** partially passes through the visible light beam splitting film **210** and the infrared light transmissive film **220** to beam into the display lens **200**. Moreover, the light entering the display lens **200** is a polarized light. The light entering the display lens **200** passes through the lens in the display lens **200**, and is reflected by the reflective polarizing film **240**. The reflected light from the reflective polarizing film **240** passes through the quarter-wave plate **250** where phase delay is realized and the phase changes by 90° , and is then reflected by the visible light beam splitting film **210** and the infrared light transmissive film **220** to enter the lens in the display lens **200**. Then, the reflected light from the visible light beam splitting film **210** and the infrared light transmissive film **220** passes again through the lens in the display lens **200**, the quarter-wave plate **250**, and the reflective polarizing film **240** and exits from a side of the display lens **200** away from the display screen **100**. In this way, the optical path of the visible light emitted from the display screen **100** is pancaked at the display lens **200**.

(79) In the eye tracking apparatus disclosed in some optional embodiments, the eye tracking apparatus further comprises an infrared device, and a light exit side of the infrared device faces the eye **400**, so that the infrared light emitted by the infrared device is reflected by the eye **400** and passes through the display lens **200** to beam into the eye tracking camera **300**. Exemplarily, the infrared device may be an infrared LED lamp.

(80) In some embodiments provided by the disclosure, the infrared light emitted from the infrared device, after being reflected from the eye **400**, may directly pass through the display lens **200** to beam into the eye tracking camera **300**. That is, the infrared light will not be repeatedly pancaked to extend the optical path when passing through the display lens **200**. Moreover, the infrared light transmissive film **220** is advantageous for the infrared light to pass through, further increasing brightness of the light entering the eye tracking camera **300**.

(81) In this embodiment, the eye tracking camera **300** performs imaging based on the infrared light reflected from the eye **400**. During movement of the eye **400**, the position of the pupil of the eye **400** imaged by the eye tracking camera **300** changes. Exemplarily, the eye tracking apparatus may be a headset. Specifically, when the eye tracking apparatus is worn on the head, the eye tracking camera **300** and the infrared LED lamp do not move relative to the head, so that the corneal

reflection position is relatively fixed. During movement of the eye **400**, the pupil center moves relative to the corneal reflection position. As such, a gaze/fixation position of the eye **400** may be determined by the eye tracking camera **300** tracking positional changes of the pupil center of the eye **400**.

(82) In some optional embodiments, the eye tracking apparatus further comprises a housing **500**. The housing **500** is a basic structural member, which may provide a mounting base for the display screen **100**, the display lens **200**, and/or the eye tracking camera **300**. Further optionally, the display screen **100**, the display lens **200**, and/or the eye tracking camera **300** may all be directly and/or indirectly disposed in the housing **500**. Further optionally, the display screen **100**, the display lens **200**, and/or the eye tracking camera **300** may all be directly or indirectly fixed in the housing **500** to ensure a fixed relative position between the display screen **100**, the display lens **200**, and the eye tracking camera **300**, thereby ensuring eye tracking accuracy of the eye tracking apparatus. Further optionally, the housing **500** may be a headset housing to facilitate a user to wear the eye tracking apparatus.

(83) In another aspect, the disclosure further provides a virtual reality apparatus. The virtual reality apparatus comprises the eye tracking apparatus described supra.

(84) The virtual reality apparatus provided by the disclosure has same technical features as the eye tracking apparatus and can achieve same technical effects, which will not be detailed here.

(85) Optionally, the virtual reality apparatus described herein may be VR glasses. Further optionally, the virtual reality apparatus has a headset housing to facilitate a user to wear the virtual reality apparatus.

(86) After considering the specification and implementing the present disclosure, those skilled in the art would readily contemplate other embodiments of the disclosure. The present disclosure intends to cover any alteration, use or adaptation to the disclosure, and such alterations, uses or adaptations follow the general principle of the disclosure and encompass the common knowledge or customary means in the art not disclosed herein. The specification and the embodiments are only deemed as exemplary; the substantive scope and spirit of the disclosure is stated in the appending claims.

(87) It should be understood that the disclosure is not limited to those accurate structures having been described supra and illustrated in the accompanying drawings and may be subjected to various modifications and changes without departing from its scope. The scope of the disclosure is only limited by the appending claims.

Claims

1. An eye tracking apparatus, characterized by comprising: a display screen, a display lens, and an eye tracking camera, the display screen and the display lens being oppositely disposed, and a displaying surface of the display screen facing the display lens; wherein the eye tracking camera is disposed adjacent to an edge of the display screen, a view-finding side of the eye tracking camera faces the display lens, an included angle between an optical axis of the eye tracking camera and an optical axis of the display lens ranges from 8.5° to 9.5° , and the eye tracking camera receives light passing through the display lens, wherein the display lens further comprises a polarizing film, a reflective polarizing film and a quarter-wave plate, wherein the reflective polarizing film and the quarter-wave plate are stacked at a side of the polarizing film proximal to the eye tracking camera, the reflective polarizing film is disposed between the quarter-wave plate and the polarizing film.
2. The eye tracking apparatus according to claim 1, characterized in that a center of the display screen is disposed at the optical axis of the display lens, wherein a radial distance from a center to an edge of the display lens is referred to as a first distance, a vertical distance between the eye tracking camera and the center of the display screen is referred to as a second distance, and the first distance is greater than or equal to the second distance.

3. The eye tracking apparatus according to claim 2, characterized in that the eye tracking apparatus meets at least one of the following: the first distance ranges from 22 mm to 25 mm, and a vertical distance from an edge of a side of the display screen proximal to the eye tracking camera to the center of the display screen ranges from 13 mm to 17 mm.
4. The eye tracking apparatus according to claim 1, characterized in that the eye tracking apparatus meets at least one of the following: an object distance of the eye tracking camera ranges from 28 mm to 37 mm, and a field of view of the eye tracking camera ranges from 70° to 85°.
5. The eye tracking apparatus according to claim 4, characterized in that a distance between the eye tracking camera and a side of the display lens facing away from the eye tracking camera ranges from 15 mm to 18 mm.
6. The eye tracking apparatus according to claim 1, characterized in that a resolution of an image produced by the eye tracking camera is 400*400.
7. The eye tracking apparatus according to claim 1, characterized in that the display lens further comprises a visible light beam splitting film and an infrared light transmissive film, wherein the visible light beam splitting film and the infrared light transmissive film are both disposed at a side of the display lens proximal to the eye tracking camera, and the infrared light transmissive film is stacked at a side of the visible light beam splitting film proximal to the eye tracking camera.
8. The eye tracking apparatus according to claim 7, characterized in that the visible light beam splitting film and the infrared light transmissive film are disposed at a side proximal to the eye tracking camera.
9. The eye tracking apparatus according to claim 1, characterized by further comprising an infrared device, wherein a light exit side of the infrared device faces an eye, and an infrared light emitted from the infrared device is reflected by the eye to pass through the display lens and beam into the eye tracking camera.
10. A virtual reality apparatus, characterized by comprising an eye tracking apparatus, wherein the eye tracking apparatus comprises: a display screen, a display lens, and an eye tracking camera, the display screen and the display lens being oppositely disposed, and a displaying surface of the display screen facing the display lens; wherein the eye tracking camera is disposed adjacent to an edge of the display screen, a view-finding side of the eye tracking camera faces the display lens, an included angle between an optical axis of the eye tracking camera and an optical axis of the display lens ranges from 8.5° to 9.5°, and the eye tracking camera receives light passing through the display lens, wherein the display lens further comprises a polarizing film, a reflective polarizing film and a quarter-wave plate, wherein the reflective polarizing film and the quarter-wave plate are stacked at a side of the polarizing film proximal to the eye tracking camera, the reflective polarizing film is disposed between the quarter-wave plate and the polarizing film.
11. The virtual reality apparatus according to claim 10, characterized in that a center of the display screen is disposed at the optical axis of the display lens, wherein a radial distance from a center to an edge of the display lens is referred to as a first distance, a vertical distance between the eye tracking camera and the center of the display screen is referred to as a second distance, and the first distance is greater than or equal to the second distance.
12. The virtual reality apparatus according to claim 11, characterized in that the eye tracking apparatus meets at least one of the following: the first distance ranges from 22 mm to 25 mm, and a vertical distance from an edge of a side of the display screen proximal to the eye tracking camera to the center of the display screen ranges from 13 mm to 17 mm.
13. The virtual reality apparatus according to claim 10, characterized in that the eye tracking apparatus meets at least one of the following: an object distance of the eye tracking camera ranges from 28 mm to 37 mm, and a field of view of the eye tracking camera ranges from 70° to 85°.
14. The virtual reality apparatus according to claim 13, characterized in that a distance between the eye tracking camera and a side of the display lens facing away from the eye tracking camera ranges from 15 mm to 18 mm.

15. The virtual reality apparatus according to claim 10, characterized in that a resolution of an image produced by the eye tracking camera is 400*400.
16. The virtual reality apparatus according to claim 10, characterized in that the display lens further comprises a visible light beam splitting film and an infrared light transmissive film, wherein the visible light beam splitting film and the infrared light transmissive film are both disposed at a side of the display lens proximal to the eye tracking camera, and the infrared light transmissive film is stacked at a side of the visible light beam splitting film proximal to the eye tracking camera.
17. The virtual reality apparatus according to claim 16, characterized in that visible light beam splitting film and the infrared light transmissive film are disposed at a side proximal to the eye tracking camera.
18. The virtual reality apparatus according to claim 10, characterized by further comprising an infrared device, wherein a light exit side of the infrared device faces an eye, and an infrared light emitted from the infrared device is reflected by the eye to pass through the display lens and beam into the eye tracking camera.
-